

Kadal Systems

Satellite messaging and distress alerts for small fishing vessels

Seed round, July 2026

Kollam, Kerala

The problem

- A 32 foot fishing boat loses mobile signal about 18 km from shore.
- From there until it returns, nobody on land knows where it is or whether it is safe.
- Kerala lost 41 fishermen at sea in 2025. Most were found late, not never.
- A boat owner who cannot reach his crew also cannot tell them where the fish are.

What we do

- A satellite terminal fitted on the vessel, Rs 14,500, plus Rs 1,800 a year for airtime.
- One button distress alert that reaches the coast guard and the harbour society.
- Weather warnings pushed to the vessel before the boat commits to a run.
- Catch logging, which is what actually makes the owner switch it on every day.

Proof it works

- 3,100 units deployed across five harbour societies.
- 37 distress alerts relayed since launch, of which 9 became rescues.
- 71 percent of year one subscribers renewed in year two.
- The safety case is settled. The commercial case is what this round is about.

The honest problem

- 2,860 of 3,100 units were bought under a state subsidy scheme.
- Only 240 owners have paid full price out of their own pocket.
- Until that number is in the thousands, this is a government programme, not a business.
- We are telling you this on slide five, not slide nineteen.

Why we think full price works

- Full price units grew from 12 in Q1 FY26 to 65 in Q1 FY27, with no subsidy involved.
- The buyers are owners of three or more boats, who treat it as fleet equipment.
- Renewal on full price units is 88 percent against 68 percent on subsidised units.
- The catch log, not the distress button, is what they say they are paying for.

Unit economics

- Hardware contribution Rs 3,500 per unit at full price, 24.1 percent.
- Subscription contribution Rs 1,160 per vessel per year, 64 percent.
- A vessel that stays four years is worth Rs 8,140 of contribution.
- Airtime is bought wholesale on a one year contract, which is our largest single risk.

Market

- Kerala has roughly 21,000 registered mechanised and motorised fishing vessels.
- Tamil Nadu has about 33,000, Gujarat about 28,000.
- At full price penetration of 10 percent in Kerala alone the subscription base is Rs 3.8 crore.
- We are not counting subsidy driven volume in any of these numbers.

Use of funds

- Rs 4.5 crore, expected to last 15 months.
- Rs 1.6 crore: working capital for terminal inventory ahead of the post monsoon season.
- Rs 1.2 crore: a direct sales team working harbour by harbour on full price sales.
- Rs 1.0 crore: next generation terminal at a target bill of materials of Rs 6,400.
- Rs 0.7 crore: reserve.

The team

- Sujith Kumar, CEO. Marine engineer, eight years at sea, grew up in a fishing family.
- Anas Rahman, CTO. Designed terminals for a maritime tracking provider.
- Lakshmi Menon, Field Operations. Ran a state fisheries extension programme.
- 16 full time, of whom 7 are field installers across five harbours.